

Easter rituals across the world



VALENTINO DARIELL DE SOUSA/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Catholics attend an Easter vigil Saturday at Balide Church in Dili, East Timor. In D.C., a Good Friday processional put on a display. **Photos, B12**

Big revamp sought for fighting fires as dire season looks likely

BY JAKE SPRING AND BRIANNA SACKS

The Trump administration on Friday outlined the most detailed plans yet for its new Wildland Fire Service, which would overhaul how the nation fights wildfires in the run up to what experts say could be one of the worst U.S. fire seasons in

recent memory.

As intense drought conditions turn the American West into a tinderbox, firefighters and fire policy experts argue a unified super agency will help the country confront a new era of mega-fires. But congressional Democrats and public lands advocates warn it could strip away even more employees from land man-

agement agencies weakened by the U.S. DOGE Service.

The Interior Department launched the Wildland Fire Service in January, combining all firefighting operations previously overseen by the department's Bureau of Land Management, National Park Service, Fish and Wildlife Service, Bureau of Indian Affairs, Office of Aviation

Services and Office of Wildland Fire. On Friday, the administration elaborated how it would operate the new agency for fiscal year 2027, proposing a \$4 billion budget and 4,500-person staff. The plan also would fund a new center for centralizing wildfire intelligence.

"The legacy approach to Federal wildland fire risk mitigation

and response is fractured and has led to significant coordination and cost inefficiencies, which endanger lives, infrastructure, and national treasures," the budget proposal said.

Some experts say the U.S. has entered an era of larger, faster-spreading fires that the old decentralized federal system is no

SEE WILDFIRES ON A18

Trump weighs more Cabinet changes but shy of 'shake-up'

In wake of Bondi's ouster, president pushes back on reports of more upheaval

BY NATALIE ALLISON

After ousting two of his highest-profile Cabinet members from their posts, President Donald Trump is considering making more changes to his administration's top leadership, according to advisers — a decision that would accelerate the once-slow pace of his second-term staff departures.

But Trump, who sought to avoid high-profile departures during the first year back in the White House — often publicly standing by Cabinet members even as they faced scrutiny — is also reluctant to engage in a large-scale shake-up of his Cabinet, and in some cases has pushed to counter reporting that he has soured on certain officials.

On the heels of news of the firing Thursday of his attorney general, Pam Bondi, Trump wanted to make a "very strong" statement reaffirming his support for another official rumored to be on the chopping block, Director of National Intelligence Tulsi Gabbard, according to a White House official, who spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss internal conversations. As a result, his rapid-response account on X

posted a statement from Trump's communications director saying that the president "has total confidence" in Gabbard, "and any insinuation otherwise is totally fake news."

Gabbard, who has a long history of criticizing U.S. involvement in Middle East conflicts — specifically the notion of a war with Iran — has continued to brief the president on intelligence, even as Trump earlier this week told reporters that Gabbard was "a little bit different in her thought process than me" on Iran.

Gabbard is "safe" in her role for the time being, the White House official said.

Two others in his Cabinet may be less secure. Labor Secretary Lori Chavez-DeRemer and Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick have both been under Trump's scrutiny for a possible exit, according to the same official and a second White House official.

Chavez-DeRemer, who is facing misconduct allegations that include an alleged affair with a staffer and drinking in her office, has so far remained in her role despite top officials in her agency resigning amid the scandal. And Lutnick's style of freelancing policy ideas and deals without prior approval has long prompted eye rolls from aides and others in the White House, according to people close to Trump, who also spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss personnel issues.

SEE CABINET ON A4



D.C. FIRE DEPARTMENT

Metrobus slams into D.C. restaurant

Authorities say the Shaw eatery was unoccupied and that three people sustained "minor injuries": the bus driver, a bus passenger and the driver of an SUV that had collided with the bus. **Story, B18**

Va. church on Vance cover baffles its congregants

BY DANIELLE PAQUETTE

The modest church on the cover of Vice President JD Vance's new memoir unpacking his Catholic faith has a tiny but loyal congregation.

What it doesn't have, members said: any connection to Vance or Catholicism.

There are a couple dozen regulars at Mt. Zion United Methodist

Church in rural southwestern Virginia, according to one, 78-year-old Marshall Funk, who attended his first service there in his mother's womb. As they gathered Thursday evening for a potluck at the brick building with a white steeple — a classic Methodist style — Funk heard not a peep about politics. As far as he knew, nobody was aware that the White House's second-in-com-

mand had broadcast an image of what Funk called his "second home."

Vance, to his knowledge, had never visited.

"I'd have to see it to believe it," the retired dairy farmer said of the cover.

As congregants dug into broccoli casserole, the internet was chattering about Vance's memoir

SEE VANCE ON A4

THE NATION

The Artemis II astronauts are now more than halfway to the moon. **A3**

SPORTS

In second straight game, starting pitching costs the Nats in 10-5 loss. **B1**



ARTS & STYLE

The right's embrace of Adam Carolla cost him gigs — but not his edge.

BUSINESS

Seniors face higher costs as Medicare Advantage plans flee rural areas. **B6**



TRAVEL

Six destinations for a summer vacation that won't break the bank.

THE REGION

Virginians are split over Democratic push to pad seats in Congress. **B12**

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SUNDAY COUPON INSERTS

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For sale: Data to 'expose' troops

CHINESE FIRMS TRY TO CASH IN ON WAR

They use AI for detailed intel on U.S. movements

BY CATE CADELL AND LYRIC LI

As the war in Iran erupted five weeks ago, social media sleuths across Western and Chinese platforms flagged a wave of viral posts detailing equipment at U.S. bases, the movements of American carrier groups and granular breakdowns of how military aircraft were assembling for strikes on Tehran.

The intelligence came from a fast growing new market: Chinese firms — some with links to the People's Liberation Army — marrying artificial intelligence with open-source data to market information they claim can "expose" the movements of U.S. forces.

Beijing has sought to distance itself from any direct involvement in the Iran war, but the firms — many of which have emerged in the past five years as part of the government's push to harness private AI for military use — are capitalizing on the conflict.

U.S. officials and intelligence experts are divided over whether Chinese firms' publicly marketed

SEE INTELLIGENCE ON A13

Missing airman: Search continues as Iran posts a capture reward. **A13**

War's fiscal fallout may get worse for America

Hormuz choke hold tees up shortages, rising rates and higher energy bills

BY DAVID J. LYNCH

Amazon is adding a fuel surcharge to its e-commerce deliveries. Mortgage rates have risen to their highest mark in seven months. And consumers may soon see higher prices for soda bottles and detergents.

These are all early indications of the Iran war's impact on the U.S. economy. So far, the costs of the joint U.S.-Israeli military campaign have been modest, especially compared with the economic turmoil roiling Asia, and U.S. growth remains solid. On Friday, the Labor Department said employers added a robust 178,000 jobs in March.

But like thunderclaps that herald an advancing storm, rising energy bills, interest rates and supply shortfalls may be warnings of worse to come.

Americans, by a margin of 56 percent to 7 percent, expect the war to have a "mostly negative impact" on their personal financial situation, according to a March 31 Ipsos poll. A Middle East conflict that lasts for several more months would almost certainly spread higher prices and supply chain disruption beyond Asia and

SEE ECONOMY ON A2